Thomas Nellen

Economic Advisor · Swiss National Bank and Study Center Gerzensee

Payment economics · financial market infrastructures · money markets and monetary policy implementation · financial stability

thomasnellen.github.io thomas.a.nellen@gmail.com RePEc LinkedIn

October 2026

EXPERIENCE

since 2026 **Economic Advisor, Study Center Gerzensee**

since 2025 **Economic Advisor, Swiss National Bank** — Stress Testing and Data Science, Financial Stability, Zurich

Liquidity stress testing. Data science. Research function.

2011–2025 **Economic Advisor, Swiss National Bank** — Oversight, Financial Stability, Zurich

Lead policy and regulation. Deputy CPMI member (Committee for Payment and Market Infrastructures), member of the CPMI–IOSCO Steering Group and the CPMI–IOSCO Policy Standing Group. Research function.

2017–2018 **Secondment, Federal Reserve Bank of New York** — Money and Payments Studies, Research Group

2006–2010 **Senior Economist, Swiss National Bank** — Oversight, Financial Stability, Bern

Lead overseer of the Swiss central counterparty and central securities depository. Member of the LCH and Eurex international oversight colleges.

2002–2005 **Economist, Swiss National Bank** — Financial Market Infrastructures, Zurich

Establishment of new oversight function. Member of the drafting team for the National Bank Act and the National Bank Ordinance, and of the crisis management steering group with the Ministry of Finance and the Federal Banking Commission.

1997–2001 **Junior Economist, Swiss National Bank** — Banking Operations Analysis, Zurich

Established the banking operations analysis function and the bank's active participation in the CPMI.

2003, 2005 **World Bank technical assistance missions** — Costa Rica, payment systems; Brazil, securities settlement system

EDUCATION

2006–2010 **PhD in Economics (Dr. rer. oec.), University of Bern**

Thesis: *Essays in Payment Economics*. Supervisors: Ernst Baltensperger and Antoine Martin.

1998–2000 **PhD Program, Study Center Gerzensee** — microeconomics, macroeconomics, econometrics

1992–1997 **Master in Economics (lic. rer. pol.), University of Bern**

Microeconomics and microeconometrics, with mathematics as a minor. Erasmus exchange at the University of Maastricht, 1996–1997.

ongoing **Advanced methods in data science**

Machine learning, causal machine learning and Bayesian networks. Study Center Gerzensee and GSERM, the Global School in Empirical Research Methods.

REFEREED JOURNAL ARTICLES

2021 Monnet, Cyril and Thomas Nellen. The collateral cost of clearing. *Journal of Money, Credit and Banking* 53(5), 939–970.

2021 Meuli, Jonas, Thomas Nellen and Thomas Nitschka. Covered bonds, loan growth and bank funding: the Swiss experience since 1932. *International Finance* 24(1), 77–94.

2020 Kraenzlin, Sébastien, Christoph Meyer and Thomas Nellen. Covid-19 and regional shifts in Swiss retail payments. *Swiss Journal of Economics and Statistics* 156:14.

2019 Nellen, Thomas. Intraday liquidity facilities, late settlement fee and coordination. *Journal of Banking and Finance* 106, 124–131.

2019 Guggenheim, Basil, Mario Meichle and Thomas Nellen. Confederation debt management since 1970. *Swiss Journal of Economics and Statistics* 155:15.

2015 Mägerle, Jürg and Thomas Nellen. Interoperability between central counterparties. *Journal of Financial Market Infrastructures* 4(2), 49–71.

2015 Kraenzlin, Sébastien and Thomas Nellen. Access policy and money market segmentation. *Journal of Monetary Economics* 71, 1–12.

2010 Kraenzlin, Sébastien and Thomas Nellen. Daytime is money. *Journal of Money, Credit and Banking* 42(8), 1689–1702.

2000 Heller, Daniel, Thomas Nellen and Andy Sturm. Swiss Interbank Clearing. *Financial Markets and Portfolio Management* 14(4).

MONOGRAPHS AND THESIS

2020 Ebner, Till, Thomas Nellen and Jörn Tenhofen. Budget control and payment behavior: evidence from Switzerland. In *Cash in the Age of Payment Diversity*, International Cash Conference, Deutsche Bundesbank.

2012 Oleschak, Robert and Thomas Nellen. Does SIC need a heart pace maker? In Hellqvist, M. and T. Laine (eds.), *Diagnostics for the Financial Markets*, Simulator Seminar Proceedings 2009–2011.

2011 Nellen, Thomas. *Essays in Payment Economics*. PhD thesis, University of Bern.

WORKING PAPERS

2023 Brown, Martin, Yves Nacht, Thomas Nellen and Helmut Stix. Cashless payment and consumer spending. *SNB Working Paper* 6/2023.

2022 Alexandrova-Kabadjova, B. et al. (20 authors, incl. T. Nellen). Intraday liquidity around the world. *BIS Working Paper* 1089.

2021 Ebner, Till, Thomas Nellen and Jörn Tenhofen. The rise of digital watchers. *SNB Working Paper* 1/2021.

Working paper versions of the journal articles above are omitted.

WORK IN PROGRESS

revision Capel, Manuel and Thomas Nellen. Periods of inactivity and central queuing arrangements.

revision Capel, Manuel and Thomas Nellen. Payment fragility and central queuing arrangements.

revision Capel, Manuel, Thomas Nellen and Paolo Vanini. Bank stress event prediction.

revision Nellen, Thomas, Silvio Schumacher and Flurina Strasser. Settlement liquidity in SIC.

drafting Brown, Martin, Giannina Elsaid-Miller, Nicole Hentschel and Thomas Nellen. From cash to generation Z: cash usage by the young.

drafting Fuhrer, Lucas and Thomas Nellen. The relative supply of safety: the spread between treasuries and covered bonds.

drafting Nellen, Thomas. Factors of resiliency: the Swiss franc repo market during turbulent times.

POLICY PUBLICATIONS

2022 Nellen, Thomas. Stablecoins as new financial market infrastructures? *Pay*, the payments professional magazine of SIX, 7.

2021 Ebner, Till, Thomas Nellen and Jörn Tenhofen. The rise of digital watchers. *SUERF Policy Brief*.

2010 Oleschak, Robert, Thomas Nellen und Beatrice Kraus. Simulator bestätigt effiziente Zahlungsabwicklung. *CLEARIT*, Dezember.

INTERNATIONAL COMMITTEE REPORTS *selected*

2022	Application of the Principles for Financial Market Infrastructures to stablecoin arrangements. CPMI–IOSCO.
2022	Client clearing: access and portability. CPMI–IOSCO.
2017	Resilience of central counterparties: further guidance on the PFMI. CPMI–IOSCO.
2017	Recovery of financial market infrastructures. CPMI–IOSCO.
2012	Principles for Financial Market Infrastructures. CPMI–IOSCO.
2005	Central bank oversight of payment and settlement systems. CPMI.

Contributor to further CPMI, CPMI-IOSCO and CGFS reports since 2000.

TEACHING

2022	Payments and Central Banks. Central Bank Course on Money and Payments, Study Center Gerzensee.
2012–2018	Money Markets and Financial Stability. Central Bank Course on Financial Stability, Study Center Gerzensee.
2013–2016	An Economic Approach to Financial Regulation. MIME master program, Universities of Bern and Basel.
1999–2000	Retail Payments and RTGS Payment Systems. Joint Vienna Institute.

PRESENTATIONS AND DISCUSSIONS *selected*

2025	From cash to generation Z. Economics of Payments XIV, Rome. Payment fragility and central queuing arrangements. International Conference on Payments and Securities Settlement, Ottawa.
2024	Payment fragility and central queuing arrangements. Economics of Payments XIII, Vienna. Discussion of Goldstein, Yang and Zeng, Swiss Society for Financial Market Research, Zurich.
2022	Payment networks and bank stress nowcasting. Economics of Payments XI, Bank of Canada, and De Nederlandsche Bank.
2021	The rise of digital watchers. BIS seminar. Discussion of Huynh, Molnár, Shcherbakov and Yu, Economics of Payments X, Bank of Finland.
2018	Settlement liquidity in SIC. Economics of Payments IX, BIS Basel, and Federal Reserve Bank of New York.
2012–2014	The collateral cost of clearing. Bank of England, Federal Reserve Bank of New York, Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, University of Basel.
2011	Interoperability between central counterparties. Bank of England, Bank of Canada, BIS, Economics of Payments V, Washington.

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

referee	Journal of Money, Credit and Banking; Journal of Banking and Finance; Journal of Macroeconomics; Journal of Financial Market Infrastructures; Computational Economics.
committees	Co-organizer and/or scientific committee member: Economics of Payments; BIS–CEPR–Gerzensee–SFI Financial Intermediation Conference; Summer Workshop on Money, Banking, Payments and Finance.
past	Scientific Committee, Annual Conference of the International Journal of Central Banking (2026). Publication Committee, Swiss National Bank (2012–2017).